

BANK EMPLOYEE POLICY MANUAL

Reference Guide for Employee Chatbot System

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□ **Purpose:** This document serves as the primary reference for the Bank Employee Chatbot System. It covers key operational policies, compliance requirements, customer service protocols, and internal procedures to assist employees in day-to-day banking operations.

1. Employee Code of Conduct

All bank employees are expected to uphold the highest standards of integrity, professionalism, and ethical behavior. The following policies govern conduct in the workplace and in interactions with customers and colleagues.

1.1 Professional Standards

- Treat all customers and colleagues with respect, dignity, and fairness regardless of background.
- Maintain punctuality and adhere to assigned work schedules; notify supervisors of absences at least 2 hours in advance.
- Dress in accordance with the bank's professional attire policy at all times during working hours.
- Refrain from engaging in personal activities (social media, personal calls) during customer-facing hours.
- Represent the bank positively in all public and professional settings.

1.2 Conflict of Interest

Employees must avoid situations where personal interests conflict with those of the bank or its customers.

- Disclose any personal financial relationships with customers or vendors to HR.
- Do not accept gifts or favors exceeding PKR 1,000 in value from customers or vendors.
- Recuse yourself from decisions involving family members or close associates.
- Report all potential conflicts of interest in writing to the Compliance Officer within 5 business days.

1.3 Disciplinary Actions

□ **Note:** Violations of the Code of Conduct may result in disciplinary action ranging from a verbal warning to termination, depending on severity and frequency.

Violation Level	Examples	Action
Level 1 – Minor	Late arrival, dress code	Verbal warning
Level 2 – Moderate	Customer complaint, policy breach	Written warning + PIP
Level 3 – Serious	Harassment, data misuse	Suspension or termination
Level 4 – Gross Misconduct	Fraud, theft, bribery	Immediate termination + legal action

2. Customer Service Policies

Delivering exceptional customer service is at the core of our banking mission. Every employee plays a vital role in ensuring customers feel valued and supported.

2.1 Customer Interaction Standards

- Greet every customer with a warm welcome within 30 seconds of their arrival or contact initiation.
- Use the customer's name (if known) during interactions to personalize the experience.
- Listen actively and avoid interrupting customers while they are explaining their needs.
- Provide clear, accurate, and concise information — avoid jargon where possible.
- End all interactions with a thank-you and confirmation that the customer's needs have been addressed.

2.2 Complaint Handling Procedure

All customer complaints must be handled promptly and professionally using the following steps:

1. Acknowledge the complaint and apologize for the inconvenience.
2. Log the complaint in the Customer Complaint Management System (CCMS) within 1 hour.
3. Investigate the root cause and consult relevant department if needed.
4. Provide a resolution within 3 business days for standard complaints.

- 5. Follow up with the customer to confirm satisfaction after resolution.

2.3 Service Level Agreements (SLAs)

Service Type	Response Time	Resolution Time
Branch inquiry (walk-in)	Immediate	Same day
Phone inquiry	< 3 minutes hold	< 15 minutes
Email inquiry	< 4 hours	< 2 business days
Online chat support	< 2 minutes	< 30 minutes
Formal complaint	< 1 business day	< 5 business days
Transaction dispute	< 1 business day	< 10 business days

3. Account Management Policies

3.1 Account Opening Requirements

All new accounts must comply with Know Your Customer (KYC) regulations. The following documents are mandatory:

- Valid government-issued photo ID (CNIC, Passport, or Driver's License)
- Proof of address (utility bill, rental agreement — not older than 3 months)
- Source of funds declaration for accounts with initial deposits exceeding PKR 500,000
- Biometric verification (fingerprint) for all individual accounts
- Additional business documents for corporate accounts (NTN, incorporation certificate)

❑ **KYC Policy:** Under SBP regulations, all KYC data must be verified and updated every 2 years for low-risk customers and annually for high-risk customers. Incomplete KYC may result in account freezing.

3.2 Account Types & Minimum Balance Requirements

Account Type	Min. Opening Balance	Min. Monthly Balance	Maintenance Fee (if below min.)
Basic Savings	PKR 0	PKR 0	None
Standard Savings	PKR 1,000	PKR 1,000	PKR 200/month
Current Account (Individual)	PKR 10,000	PKR 10,000	PKR 500/month
Current Account (Business)	PKR 50,000	PKR 25,000	PKR 1,000/month

Account Type	Min. Opening Balance	Min. Monthly Balance	Maintenance Fee (if below min.)
Premium Account	PKR 500,000	PKR 100,000	PKR 2,500/month
Foreign Currency Account	USD 500	USD 100	USD 10/month

3.3 Account Dormancy Policy

- An account is classified as inactive after 12 consecutive months of no customer-initiated transactions.
- An account becomes dormant after 24 consecutive months of inactivity.
- Customers must be notified by SMS and email before dormancy classification.
- Dormant accounts can be reactivated at any branch with valid ID and a formal reactivation request.
- Dormant account funds are not forfeited; balances are maintained with applicable profit rates.

4. Cash Handling & Transaction Policies

4.1 Cash Handling Procedures

All cash transactions must be handled with the utmost care and accuracy. Employees must follow these procedures:

- Count all cash received from customers in full view of the customer before processing.
- Use cash counting machines for amounts exceeding PKR 10,000.
- Never leave cash unattended at the teller station at any time.
- Ensure till balances are reconciled at the start and end of every shift.
- Report any cash discrepancy immediately to the Branch Operations Manager.
- Large cash transactions (PKR 500,000+) require dual authorization from two authorized officers.

4.2 Transaction Limits

Transaction Type	Single Transaction Limit	Daily Limit	Authorization Required
Cash Deposit (Over Counter)	PKR 5,000,000	Unlimited	CTR for PKR 2.5M+
Cash Withdrawal (Over Counter)	PKR 1,000,000	PKR 2,000,000	Manager approval > 500K
ATM Withdrawal	PKR 50,000	PKR 100,000	PIN only

Transaction Type	Single Transaction Limit	Daily Limit	Authorization Required
Fund Transfer (Internal)	PKR 5,000,000	PKR 10,000,000	OTP verification
Fund Transfer (External/IBFT)	PKR 1,000,000	PKR 2,500,000	OTP + cooling period
Demand Draft / Pay Order	PKR 10,000,000	Unlimited	Manager approval

4.3 Anti-Money Laundering (AML) Compliance

□ **Legal Requirement:** All employees are legally obligated to comply with AML regulations under the Anti-Money Laundering Act 2010 and SBP guidelines. Non-compliance may result in criminal liability.

- File a Currency Transaction Report (CTR) for all cash transactions of PKR 2,500,000 or more.
- File a Suspicious Transaction Report (STR) within 7 days of identifying suspicious activity.
- Do not tip off customers that an STR or CTR has been filed — this is a criminal offense.
- Complete annual AML training — non-completion may result in suspension of banking duties.
- Structuring transactions to avoid reporting thresholds is illegal; report any such attempts.

5. Data Privacy & Information Security

5.1 Customer Data Protection

Customer data is strictly confidential and protected under the bank's privacy policy and applicable laws. Employees must:

- Never share customer account information with third parties without explicit written consent.
- Access only customer data necessary for the specific task being performed (need-to-know basis).
- Never discuss customer information in public areas or over unsecured communication channels.
- Log out of all banking systems immediately when leaving the workstation.
- Report any suspected data breach to the IT Security team within 1 hour of discovery.

5.2 System Access & Password Policy

- Passwords must be at least 12 characters and include uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and symbols.
- Passwords must be changed every 90 days; previous 10 passwords cannot be reused.
- Never share login credentials with anyone — including colleagues or supervisors.
- Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for all core banking system access.
- Unauthorized software installation on bank devices is strictly prohibited.

5.3 Acceptable Use Policy

Activity	Permitted	Conditions
Personal email on bank devices	No	Prohibited at all times
Social media (work-related)	Limited	Approved channels only
USB/external storage devices	No	Prohibited without IT approval
Remote access (VPN)	Yes	Authorized employees only
Printing customer data	Limited	Shred after use — never take home
Screen recording/screenshots	No	Unless explicitly authorized

6. Loan & Credit Policies

6.1 Loan Eligibility Criteria

The following general criteria apply to all personal loan applications. Specific products may have additional requirements.

- Minimum age: 21 years (at time of application); Maximum age: 60 years at loan maturity.
- Minimum employment tenure: 1 year for salaried; 2 years for self-employed/business owners.
- Debt-to-Income (DTI) ratio must not exceed 50% of net monthly income.
- Clean credit history — no active defaults or litigation with any financial institution.
- Minimum credit score of 600 on the eCIB report (State Bank of Pakistan).

6.2 Loan Products Overview

Loan Type	Max Amount	Tenure	Markup Rate	Processing Fee
Personal Loan	PKR 2,000,000	Up to 5 years	Market rate + 2%	1% of loan amount
Home Loan	PKR 50,000,000	Up to 20 years	Market rate + 0.5%	0.5% of loan amount
Auto Loan	PKR 10,000,000	Up to 7 years	Market rate + 1%	PKR 10,000 flat

Loan Type	Max Amount	Tenure	Markup Rate	Processing Fee
Business Loan (SME)	PKR 25,000,000	Up to 10 years	Market rate + 1.5%	1% of loan amount
Agriculture Loan	PKR 5,000,000	Up to 5 years	Subsidized rate	PKR 5,000 flat

6.3 Loan Processing Timeline

Standard processing timelines apply. Delays beyond these must be escalated to the Credit Department Manager.

- Personal Loan: Decision within 5 business days of complete documentation submission.
- Home/Auto Loan: Decision within 10 business days (includes property/vehicle valuation).
- Business/SME Loan: Decision within 15 business days (includes financial analysis).
- Disbursement within 2 business days of loan approval and document execution.

7. Human Resources Policies

7.1 Leave Policy

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement	Carryover Allowed	Notice Required
Annual Leave	20 working days	Up to 10 days	3 days advance
Sick Leave	10 working days	No	Same day (before 10 AM)
Casual Leave	10 working days	No	1 day advance
Maternity Leave	90 calendar days	N/A	30 days advance
Paternity Leave	7 calendar days	N/A	7 days advance
Hajj Leave	Once in service	N/A	60 days advance
Study/Exam Leave	5 working days/year	No	2 weeks advance

7.2 Performance Management

All employees undergo a formal performance review twice a year (mid-year and end-year). The evaluation is based on:

- Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) agreed upon at the start of each review period.
- Core competency ratings: communication, teamwork, initiative, customer focus, and compliance.
- 360-degree feedback from peers, direct reports, and supervisors.
- Achievement of sales targets and customer satisfaction scores (CSAT/NPS).

7.3 Training & Development

- All new employees must complete a 4-week onboarding program before assuming duties.
- Mandatory annual training: AML/CFT, Data Privacy, Code of Conduct, and Information Security.
- Employees are eligible to apply for external training sponsorship after 1 year of service.
- E-learning portal access is provided to all employees for self-paced professional development.

8. Regulatory Compliance

8.1 Key Regulatory Frameworks

The bank operates under the following regulatory frameworks. Employees must familiarize themselves with applicable regulations:

Regulation	Authority	Key Requirement
Banking Companies Ordinance 1962	SBP	Core banking operations
Anti-Money Laundering Act 2010	FMU / SBP	AML/CFT compliance
Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act 2016	FIA	Cybercrime prevention
Foreign Exchange Regulations Act	SBP	Forex transactions
Companies Act 2017	SECP	Corporate governance
Consumer Protection Law	SBP BPD	Customer rights

8.2 Whistleblower Policy

☐ **Protection:** Employees who report misconduct in good faith are protected from retaliation under the bank's Whistleblower Policy and applicable law.

- Report fraud, corruption, or policy violations through the dedicated Ethics Hotline: 0800-BANK-01.
- Reports can be submitted anonymously via the Ethics Portal on the intranet.
- All reports are investigated by an independent Compliance Committee within 30 days.
- Retaliation against whistleblowers is a Level 4 misconduct offense (immediate termination).

9. Employee Chatbot — Usage Guide

This policy document is the knowledge base for the Bank Employee Chatbot. The following guidelines apply to using the chatbot system:

9.1 What the Chatbot Can Help With

- Answering policy-related queries from any section of this document.
- Step-by-step guidance on standard operating procedures (SOPs).
- Transaction limit lookups and account type comparisons.
- SLA reference and complaint escalation guidance.
- Leave balance inquiries and HR policy clarifications.
- Regulatory compliance FAQs and AML reporting guidance.

9.2 Chatbot Limitations

❑ Important: The chatbot provides general policy guidance only. For complex, sensitive, or customer-specific situations, always consult your supervisor or the relevant department directly.

- The chatbot cannot access live customer account data or make system changes.
- Legal advice must be sought from the bank's Legal & Compliance department.
- Chatbot responses are based on policies current at time of last update — always verify for time-sensitive matters.

9.3 Escalation Matrix

Query Type	Primary Contact	Escalation Contact
Account operations	Branch Operations Manager	Regional Operations Head
Loan queries	Credit Officer	Credit Department Manager
Compliance / AML	Branch Compliance Officer	Group Compliance Officer
IT / System issues	IT Help Desk (Ext. 100)	IT Manager
HR queries	HR Business Partner	HR Director
Customer complaints	Branch Manager	Customer Experience Head
Legal / Regulatory	Legal Department	Chief Legal Officer

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